

# Education Policies: NEP 2020, NCF-SE 2023, NIPUN Bharat, PM SHRI, Samagra Shiksha

शिक्षा नीतियाँ: राष्ट्रीय शिक्षा नीति 2020, NCF-SE 2023, निपुण भारत, पीएम श्री, समग्र शिक्षा

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## Education Policies: NEP 2020, NCF-SE 2023, NIPUN Bharat, PM SHRI, Samagra Shiksha

This is the core "educational policies" block of the syllabus. UPSC asks dates, numbers, full forms, who-launched-what, and the exact structure of each scheme. Read the tables twice.

### 1. NEP 2020 (राष्ट्रीय शिक्षा नीति 2020): how it came about

- India's **third** national education policy, after **NPE 1968** and **NPE 1986** (modified **1992**). It replaced a 34-year-old policy.
- Two committees prepared it: the **T.S.R. Subramanian Committee** (report **2016**) and then the drafting committee chaired by **Dr K. Kasturirangan** (former ISRO chief), constituted **June 2017**, which submitted the draft on **31 May 2019**.
- The **Union Cabinet** approved NEP 2020 on **29 July 2020**. At the same meeting the **Ministry of Human Resource Development (MHRD)** was renamed the **Ministry of Education (शिक्षा मंत्रालय)**.

- NEP is a **policy, not a law**. Education is on the **Concurrent List (Entry 25, List III)**, so States implement it through their own schemes, with Samagra Shiksha and PM SHRI as the main central funding channels.
- Five foundational pillars: **Access, Equity, Quality, Affordability, Accountability** (पहुँच, समता, गुणवत्ता, वहनीयता, जवाबदेही).
- The document has **27 chapters in four parts**: Part I School Education (Ch. 1–8), Part II Higher Education (Ch. 9–19), Part III Other key areas (professional education, adult education, Indian languages, technology, online education), Part IV Making it happen (CABE, financing, implementation).

| Part I<br>chapter | Theme                                            |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 1                 | Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE)        |
| 2                 | Foundational Literacy and Numeracy (FLN)         |
| 3                 | Curtailing dropout, universal access             |
| 4                 | Curriculum and pedagogy in schools               |
| 5                 | Teachers                                         |
| 6                 | Equitable and inclusive education                |
| 7                 | School complexes/clusters                        |
| 8                 | Standard-setting and accreditation (SSSA, SQAAC) |

## 2. NEP 2020: the school-education provisions UPSC asks

### The 5+3+3+4 structure (replacing 10+2)

| Stage (चरण)                | Ages      | Grades                                         | Pedagogy                                                     |
|----------------------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Foundational<br>(बुनियादी) | 3–8       | 3 years<br>Anganwadi/Balvatika<br>+ Grades 1–2 | Play and activity<br>based                                   |
| Preparatory<br>(प्रारंभिक) | 8–11      | Grades 3–5                                     | Play, discovery,<br>activity, light<br>textbooks             |
| Middle (मध्य)              | 11–<br>14 | Grades 6–8                                     | Subject teachers,<br>experiential;<br>vocational<br>exposure |
| Secondary<br>(माध्यमिक)    | 14–<br>18 | Grades 9–12 (two<br>phases: 9–10, 11–12)       | Multidisciplinary,<br>choice,<br>semesters                   |

Note the two 3-year blocks: the Foundational stage is **5 years** because it adds three pre-school years to Grades 1–2.

## Key targets and numbers

| Target                                                         | Figure                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Public investment in education                                 | <b>6% of GDP</b> (first recommended by the Kothari Commission 1964–66)   |
| Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) in school, pre-school to secondary | <b>100% by 2030</b>                                                      |
| GER in higher education                                        | <b>50% by 2035</b> (from 26.3% in 2018)                                  |
| Out-of-school children to be brought back                      | about <b>2 crore</b>                                                     |
| Universal FLN                                                  | NEP said by <b>2025</b> ; the mission (NIPUN) set <b>2026-27</b>         |
| Vocational exposure                                            | at least <b>50% of learners by 2025</b>                                  |
| Minimum teacher qualification                                  | <b>4-year integrated B.Ed. by 2030</b>                                   |
| Continuous professional development (CPD)                      | at least <b>50 hours per year</b> per teacher                            |
| Pupil-teacher ratio                                            | under <b>30:1</b> at each school; under <b>25:1</b> where SEDGs are many |
| National Professional Standards for Teachers (NPST)            | to be developed by NCTE (target 2022)                                    |

## Language, curriculum and assessment

- **Medium of instruction:** home language / mother tongue / local language **at least till Grade 5**,

**preferably till Grade 8 and beyond** (मातृभाषा में शिक्षण).

- **Three-language formula** continues with flexibility; **no language will be imposed**; at least **two of the three languages must be native to India**. Sanskrit offered at all levels; foreign languages at secondary level; **Indian Sign Language** to be standardised.
- **Curriculum reduced to core essentials**; no hard separation between arts and sciences, curricular and extra-curricular, vocational and academic.
- **Vocational education from Grade 6**, with internships and a **10-day bagless period** in Grades 6–8. Coding from middle stage.
- **Board exams** (Grades 10, 12) continue but become "easier", test core competencies, and may be taken **up to two times a year** (one main, one improvement). **2026 was CBSE's first year of two Class 10 board exams**: the main exam ran 17 Feb–11 Mar and the optional second (improvement) exam ran 15–21 May. The better of the two scores counts.
- **Census examinations in Grades 3, 5 and 8** by the State to track learning, in addition to boards.
- **360-degree Holistic Progress Card (समग्र प्रगति पत्रक)** replacing marks-only report cards; self, peer and teacher assessment.
- **PARAKH** (Performance Assessment, Review and Analysis of Knowledge for Holistic Development) is the National Assessment Centre proposed by NEP; **set up in NCERT in February 2023**. It conducted the **PARAKH Rashtriya Sarvekshan on 4 December**

**2024** in Classes **3, 6 and 9**, which replaced the earlier NAS (NAS 2021 was in Classes 3, 5, 8, 10). It also prepared the **SQAAF** (titled School Quality Assessment and Assurance Framework; the NEP text calls it the School Quality Assessment and Accreditation Framework) and the **Holistic Progress Cards**.

- Early childhood: universal quality ECCE by **2030**; a **National Curricular and Pedagogical Framework for ECCE** by NCERT (this became **NCF-FS 2022**); one-year **Balvatika** before Grade 1; **3-month school preparation module** (this became **Vidya Pravesh**).

### **Equity, governance and teachers**

- **SEDGs** (Socio-Economically Disadvantaged Groups) is the umbrella term; **Gender Inclusion Fund**; **Special Education Zones**; KGBVs extended to Grade 12.
- **School complexes/clusters** (an idea from the Kothari Commission) to share resources; **Bal Bhavans**; schools as **Samajik Chetna Kendras**.
- **State School Standards Authority (SSSA)** as an independent regulator in each State; **SCERT** to frame the school quality framework.
- Teachers: TET extended to all stages; merit-based recruitment; halt to frequent transfers; **National Mission for Mentoring**; teacher education moved to multidisciplinary institutions; the 4-year **Integrated Teacher Education Programme (ITEP)** began in 2023-24.

- **Supreme Court (Sept 2025, reviews dismissed May 2026):** TET is mandatory for in-service teachers to continue and be promoted; deadline **31 August 2028**.

### **Higher education in one glance (short, but asked)**

- **HECI** (Higher Education Commission of India) is NEP's proposed single regulator with **four verticals**: NHERC (regulation), NAC (accreditation), HEGC (grants), GEC (standards); medical and legal education excluded. The **Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan (VBSA) Bill, 2025** was introduced in the Lok Sabha on **15 Dec 2025** and referred to a **Joint Parliamentary Committee** on 16 Dec 2025. It would create a single regulator replacing **UGC, AICTE and NCTE** through **three councils**: Viniyaman Parishad (regulation), Gunvatta Parishad (accreditation) and Manak Parishad (standards). Unlike HECI, it has **no grant-giving arm**. It was still pending with the JPC in October 2026.
- **4-year undergraduate degree with multiple entry and exit; Academic Bank of Credits (ABC); M.Phil discontinued; National Research Foundation** (enacted as **Anusandhan NRF Act 2023**); **National Educational Technology Forum (NETF); National Credit Framework (NCrF) 2023**; common entrance tests by NTA.
- Adult education: **ULLAS / Nav Bharat Saksharta Karyakram (2022-27)** for non-literates aged **15+**; a State is "fully literate" at **95%** adult literacy. Mizoram was first (2025); Sikkim (5th) and Uttarakhand (6th)

were declared in 2026; **Ladakh** was the first fully literate UT.

### 3. NCF-SE 2023 (स्कूली शिक्षा के लिए राष्ट्रीय पाठ्यचर्या की रूपरेखा 2023)

#### The four NCFs mandated by NEP

| Framework                           | Status                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| NCF for Foundational Stage (NCF-FS) | Released <b>20 October 2022</b> (ages 3–8). First NCF under NEP           |
| NCF for School Education (NCF-SE)   | Released <b>23 August 2023</b> (full school stage)                        |
| NCF for Teacher Education (NCFTE)   | NEP assigns it to <b>NCTE in consultation with NCERT</b>                  |
| NCF for Adult Education (NCFAE)     | NEP assigns it to a new <b>NCERT constituent body for adult education</b> |

- Earlier NCFs: **1975, 1988, 2000, 2005** (NCF 2005 under Prof. **Yash Pal**). NCF-SE 2023 is the first full revision in 18 years.
- Developed by **NCERT** under the **National Steering Committee chaired by Dr K. Kasturirangan** (constituted Sept 2021), with State-level inputs collected via the **NCF mobile app survey** and District Consultations.
- **Jadui Pitara (जादुई पिटारा)**, the play-based learning-teaching material box for ages 3–8, was launched on **20 February 2023** under NCF-FS.

## Core design of NCF-SE

- Follows **5+3+3+4** and the stage-wise pedagogy above; uses a chain **Aims → Curricular Goals → Competencies → Learning Outcomes**.
- Foundational stage: development of the whole child through the **Panchakosha (पंचकोश)** view: physical (शारीरिक), life-energy (प्राणिक), mental/emotional (मानसिक), intellectual (बौद्धिक), spiritual (चैतन्यिक/आध्यात्मिक).
- **No formal written exams in the Foundational stage**; assessment through observation and portfolios; written tests from Grade 3 onwards.
- Languages are labelled **R1, R2, R3** (not "first/second language"). **Grades 9–10: three languages, at least two native to India. Grades 11–12: two languages, at least one native to India.**
- **Grades 9–10**: eight curricular areas (Humanities incl. languages; Mathematics and Computational Thinking; Vocational Education; Physical Education and Well-being; Arts; Social Science; Science; Interdisciplinary Areas).
- **Grades 11–12: semester system**, choice-based; students take two languages and **four subjects from at least two of three subject groups**, removing the rigid science/commerce/humanities streams.
- **Board exams at least twice a year**, with the better score counting; the long-term goal is on-demand board exams. Both Grade 10 and 12 boards stay.

- **Vocational education** across stages, framed as three forms of work: with life forms (agriculture, animal husbandry), with materials and machines, and in human services.
- Values and **rootedness in India** (Indian knowledge systems), environmental education, and lighter school bags.
- **New NCERT textbooks:** Grades 1–2 in 2023-24 (e.g. *Mridang, Sarangi, Joyful Mathematics*); Grades 3 and 6 in 2024-25 (*Ganita Prakash, Curiosity, Exploring Society: India and Beyond, Poorvi*); Grades 4, 5, 7, 8 in 2025-26; Grade 9 in 2026-27 (*Ganita Manjari, Understanding Society*).
- Current affairs link: **AI and Computational Thinking from Class 3 from 2026-27**, framed by CBSE and NCERT under NCF-SE; the NCERT Class 8 social science chapter on the judiciary was withdrawn after Supreme Court suo motu action (closed 1 Sept 2026).

#### 4. NIPUN Bharat (निपुण भारत)

- **Full form: National Initiative for Proficiency in Reading with Understanding and Numeracy** (समझ और संख्या ज्ञान के साथ पढ़ने में दक्षता के लिए राष्ट्रीय पहल).
- **Launched 5 July 2021** by the then Education Minister **Ramesh Pokhriyal 'Nishank'** (Dharmendra Pradhan took charge on 7 July 2021). It implements NEP's National Mission on FLN and runs **under Samagra Shiksha**, not as a separate scheme.
- **Goal:** every child attains **foundational literacy and numeracy** (बुनियादी साक्षरता एवं संख्या ज्ञान) by the end

**of Grade 3 by 2026-27.** Coverage: ages 3–9, Balvatika to Grade 3.

- **Three developmental goals:** (1) children maintain good health and well-being; (2) children become effective communicators; (3) children become involved learners and connect with their immediate environment.
- **Lakshya Soochi (लक्ष्य सूची):** stage-wise targets from Balvatika to Grade 3; the Grade 3 reading target is **reading at least 60 words per minute with comprehension.**
- **Five-tier implementation mechanism:** National, State, District, Block/Cluster, School. Teachers and head of school (HoS) are responsible for school-level tracking.
- Related tools: **Vidya Pravesh (विद्या प्रवेश),** a **3-month (12-week) play-based school preparation module for Grade 1;** **Balvatika** (one-year pre-school class in primary schools); **NISHTHA 3.0 (FLN),** with **12 online courses** on DIKSHA for pre-primary to Grade 5 teachers, launched Sept 2021; the **Foundational Learning Study (FLS) 2022** by NCERT (Grade 3, March 2022) that set benchmarks; and the **NIPUN Bharat Stakeholders' Roles and Responsibilities** document.
- NISHTHA (National Initiative for School Heads' and Teachers' Holistic Advancement) itself began on **21 August 2019** (NISHTHA 1.0, elementary, 18 modules); 2.0 for secondary (2021), 3.0 FLN (2021), 4.0 ECCE.

- Delhi angle: the Directorate of Education ran **Mission Buniyaad (2018)** for FLN; from 2025 the government reported new programmes (NEEEV, Science of Living, Rashtraneeti) replacing earlier flagship initiatives.

## 5. PM SHRI (पीएम श्री: प्रधानमंत्री स्कूल्स फॉर राइजिंग इंडिया)

- Announced by the Prime Minister on **Teachers' Day, 5 September 2022**; approved by the Union Cabinet on 7 September 2022.
- A **Centrally Sponsored Scheme** to develop **more than 14,500 schools** as **exemplar NEP 2020 schools**, across all tiers: Central (KVs, JNVs), State/UT and local-body schools.
- **Period: 2022-23 to 2026-27** (five years). **Total cost Rs 27,360 crore**, of which the **Central share is Rs 18,128 crore**. About **18 lakh students** are expected to benefit directly.
- **Fund sharing:** 60:40 Centre:State; 90:10 for NE and Himalayan States; 100% Central for UTs without legislature.
- **Selection by Challenge Mode** on the PM SHRI portal in rounds: the State/UT first signs an **MoU** to implement NEP in full; eligible schools are drawn from **UDISE+** against minimum benchmarks (own pucca building, toilets, drinking water, electricity, barrier-free access); schools self-apply, are physically verified, and an expert committee approves the list. **Maximum two schools per block / urban local body** (one elementary, one secondary/senior secondary). On **29 July 2023**

(NEP's third anniversary) the Prime Minister released the **first instalment of funds to 6,207 PM SHRI schools**.

- **Six pillars of quality** (used in the School Quality Assessment Framework, SQAF): (1) curriculum, pedagogy and assessment; (2) access and infrastructure; (3) human resources and school leadership; (4) inclusive practices and gender equity; (5) management, monitoring and governance; (6) beneficiary satisfaction.
- Features: **green school** components (solar, LED, nutrition gardens, waste management, rainwater harvesting, plastic-free), ICT and smart classrooms, labs including ATLs, vocational interventions with local industry, **Vidya Samiksha Kendra** data linkage, mentoring, and school-level **Principal's Action Plan**.
- Delhi angle: Delhi stayed out of PM SHRI under the earlier government. The present government launched its own **CM SHRI schools (2025)**; **Heritage Clubs** were opened in 75 CM SHRI schools in Sept 2026, and language labs run in CM SHRI and other schools.

## 6. Samagra Shiksha (समग्र शिक्षा)

- An **integrated Centrally Sponsored Scheme** for school education from **pre-school to Class 12**, launched in **2018-19** (effective 1 April 2018) by subsuming three schemes: **Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA, 2001)**, **Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan (RMSA, 2009)** and **Teacher Education (TE)**.

Mid-day meal (now **PM POSHAN**) is a **separate** scheme.

- **Samagra Shiksha 2.0:** approved by Cabinet on **4 August 2021** for **2021-22 to 2025-26**, aligned with NEP 2020. Outlay **Rs 2,94,283.04 crore** (Central share **Rs 1,85,398.32 crore**). The cycle ended on **31 March 2026**; a restructured "Samagra Shiksha 3.0" was under consultation in 2026, with no confirmed Cabinet approval as of early October 2026. If asked, the approved framework remains Samagra Shiksha 2.0.
- **Fund sharing:** **60:40** for States and **UTs with legislature (Delhi, Puducherry)**; **90:10** for NE and Himalayan States and J&K; **100%** Central for UTs without legislature.
- Implemented through a **State Implementation Society (SIS)** with a **Single Nodal Agency (SNA)** bank account and PFMS; planning and monitoring via **PRABANDH** portal; school data via **UDISE+**; grading via **PGI**.
- Major components: ECCE and Balvatika; **NIPUN Bharat**; **KGBVs up to Class 12**; **Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Awasiya Vidyalayas**; inclusive education for CWSN; vocational education from Class 6; ICT and digital initiatives; **NISHTHA** training; **Rani Laxmibai Atma Raksha Prashikshan** (girls' self-defence, raised to **Rs 5,000 per school per month for 3 months**); **transport allowance Rs 6,000 per child per year**; **Vidyanjali** volunteer programme; Holistic Progress Card; bagless days.

| Composite school grant (संयुक्त विद्यालय अनुदान), per year | Enrolment         |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Rs 10,000                                                  | up to 30 students |
| Rs 25,000                                                  | 31–100            |
| Rs 50,000                                                  | 101–250           |
| Rs 75,000                                                  | 251–1,000         |
| Rs 1,00,000                                                | above 1,000       |

- **10% of the composite grant** must go to the **Swachhta Action Plan**. Library grant Rs 5,000–20,000 and sports grant **Rs 5,000 / 10,000 / 25,000** (primary / upper primary / secondary and above). CWSN support of **Rs 3,500 per child per year**.
- For a Vice Principal this is the money that reaches the school: know the slabs, the Swachhta earmark, the SMC's role in the School Development Plan, and that unspent balances and utilisation certificates flow back through PFMS.

## 7. Digital and data backbone (short recall)

| Item            | Fact                                                                                                              |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DIKSHA          | National teacher/student platform, launched <b>5 September 2017</b> ; hosts NISHTHA                               |
| PM eVIDYA       | <b>17 May 2020</b> ; "One Class One Channel" DTH channels, radio, ISL content                                     |
| NDEAR           | National Digital Education Architecture blueprint, <b>29 July 2021</b>                                            |
| APAAR ID        | Automated Permanent Academic Account Registry, "One Nation One Student ID", linked to DigiLocker/ABC              |
| UDISE+ 2025-26  | About <b>1.02 crore</b> teachers (the 1-crore mark was first crossed in UDISE+ 2024-25); about 14.67 lakh schools |
| PGI 2.0 2025-26 | 1,000-point index; Chandigarh alone in Uttam-3 (766 points, 4th straight year on top); Delhi among the next four  |

### Common traps

- **Cabinet approval 29 July 2020**, not the draft date (31 May 2019) and not 2019 or 2021. Chair is **Kasturirangan**, not Subramanian (he chaired the earlier 2016 committee).
- **Preparatory = Grades 3–5 (ages 8–11)**; Foundational is **five** years because it includes three pre-school years.
- **GER 50% by 2035 is for higher education**; school GER target is 100% by 2030.
- Mother tongue "at least till Grade 5, preferably 8" — options that say "compulsory till Grade 8" are

wrong.

- NEP **did not abolish board exams**; it allowed them twice a year and added census exams in Grades 3, 5, 8.
- **NIPUN launched 5 July 2021 by Ramesh Pokhriyal**, target **2026-27**, under Samagra Shiksha (not a stand-alone CSS).
- **NCF-FS 2022 came before NCF-SE 2023**; both are by NCERT under Kasturirangan's steering committee, not by CBSE or NCTE.
- NCF-SE languages: **three in 9–10, two in 11–12**; R1/R2/R3 labels.
- **PM SHRI approved 7 Sept 2022** (announced 5 Sept); **more than 14,500 schools; Rs 27,360 crore; 2022-23 to 2026-27**; KVs and JNVs are eligible; maximum two schools per block.
- Samagra Shiksha subsumes **SSA + RMSA + Teacher Education**; not mid-day meal. **2.0 approved 4 Aug 2021**, outlay **Rs 2,94,283 crore**.
- Delhi's fund-sharing is **60:40** because it is a UT **with** legislature; UTs without legislature get 100%.
- PARAKH is a **unit of NCERT (2023)**, and its 2024 survey covered Classes **3, 6, 9** (NAS 2021 covered 3, 5, 8, 10).
- HECI (NEP) has **four** verticals including grants; the VBSA Bill 2025 has **three** councils and no grant function.

## Remember for the exam

1. NEP 2020: Cabinet approval 29 July 2020; Kasturirangan draft 31 May 2019; MHRD became Ministry of Education.
2. Structure 5+3+3+4: ages 3–8, 8–11, 11–14, 14–18.
3. Targets: 6% of GDP; higher-education GER 50% by 2035; school GER 100% by 2030; 4-year B.Ed by 2030; 50 hours CPD.
4. Mother tongue till at least Grade 5, preferably Grade 8; two of three languages must be Indian.
5. Vocational from Grade 6 with 10 bagless days; census exams in Grades 3, 5, 8; boards up to twice a year.
6. PARAKH set up Feb 2023 in NCERT; Rashtriya Sarvekshan 4 Dec 2024, Classes 3, 6, 9.
7. NCF-FS released 20 Oct 2022; Jadui Pitara 20 Feb 2023; NCF-SE released 23 Aug 2023.
8. NCF-SE: Panchakosha, R1/R2/R3, three languages in 9–10 and two in 11–12, semesters in 11–12, boards twice a year.
9. NIPUN Bharat: 5 July 2021; FLN by end of Grade 3 by 2026-27; ages 3–9; five-tier mechanism; three developmental goals.
10. Vidya Pravesh: 3-month school preparation module for Grade 1; NISHTHA 3.0 FLN has 12 courses.
11. PM SHRI: Cabinet 7 Sept 2022; more than 14,500 schools; Rs 27,360 cr (Central Rs 18,128 cr); 2022-23 to 2026-27; six pillars; challenge mode; two schools per block.

12. Samagra Shiksha: 2018-19; SSA + RMSA + TE; pre-school to Class 12; 2.0 approved 4 Aug 2021, Rs 2,94,283 cr, 2021-22 to 2025-26.
13. Composite school grant Rs 10,000 to Rs 1,00,000 by enrolment; 10% for Swachhta Action Plan.
14. Fund sharing: 60:40 States and Delhi; 90:10 NE/Himalayan/J&K; 100% for UTs without legislature.
15. ULLAS 2022-27, age 15+, fully literate = 95%; HECI four verticals; VBSA Bill 2025 (three councils, replaces UGC/AICTE/NCTE) pending with JPC.

### Quick facts

- NEP 2020 was approved by the Union Cabinet on 29 July 2020; the drafting committee was chaired by Dr K. Kasturirangan (draft submitted 31 May 2019); MHRD was renamed Ministry of Education the same day.
- NEP 2020 replaced NPE 1986 (modified 1992) and is India's third national education policy after 1968 and 1986.
- 5+3+3+4: Foundational ages 3–8 (3 pre-school years + Grades 1–2), Preparatory 8–11 (Grades 3–5), Middle 11–14 (Grades 6–8), Secondary 14–18 (Grades 9–12).
- NEP targets: 6% of GDP on education; higher-education GER 50% by 2035 (26.3% in 2018); school GER 100% by 2030; 4-year integrated B.Ed as minimum teacher qualification by 2030; 50 hours CPD a year.

- Medium of instruction in home language/mother tongue at least till Grade 5, preferably till Grade 8; three-language formula with at least two Indian languages and no language imposed.
- NEP keeps board exams (up to twice a year) and adds State census exams in Grades 3, 5 and 8; PARAKH was set up in NCERT in Feb 2023 and held the Rashtriya Sarvekshan on 4 Dec 2024 in Classes 3, 6 and 9.
- NCF for Foundational Stage was released on 20 Oct 2022 (ages 3–8); Jadui Pitara on 20 Feb 2023; NCF for School Education on 23 Aug 2023, all by NCERT under Kasturirangan's National Steering Committee.
- NCF-SE 2023: Panchakosha development, languages labelled R1/R2/R3, three languages in Grades 9–10 (two Indian), two languages in Grades 11–12, semester system in 11–12, board exams at least twice a year.
- NIPUN Bharat (National Initiative for Proficiency in Reading with Understanding and Numeracy) was launched on 5 July 2021 by Ramesh Pokhriyal 'Nishank' under Samagra Shiksha; goal: FLN for every child by end of Grade 3 by 2026-27; covers ages 3–9.
- NIPUN has three developmental goals, a Lakshya Soochi of stage-wise targets, and a five-tier mechanism (National, State, District, Block/Cluster, School); Vidya Pravesh is the 3-

month school-preparation module for Grade 1; NISHTHA 3.0 (FLN) has 12 courses.

- PM SHRI was announced on 5 Sept 2022 and approved by Cabinet on 7 Sept 2022: more than 14,500 exemplar schools, Rs 27,360 crore (Central share Rs 18,128 crore), 2022-23 to 2026-27, selection by challenge mode with at most two schools per block/ULB.
- PM SHRI has six quality pillars: curriculum-pedagogy-assessment; access and infrastructure; human resources and leadership; inclusion and gender equity; management-monitoring-governance; beneficiary satisfaction.
- Samagra Shiksha (2018-19) subsumed SSA, RMSA and Teacher Education and covers pre-school to Class 12; Samagra Shiksha 2.0 was approved on 4 Aug 2021 for 2021-22 to 2025-26 with an outlay of Rs 2,94,283 crore.
- Composite school grant: Rs 10,000 (up to 30 students), 25,000 (31–100), 50,000 (101–250), 75,000 (251–1,000), 1,00,000 (above 1,000); 10% is earmarked for the Swachhta Action Plan.
- Fund sharing under Samagra Shiksha and PM SHRI: 60:40 for States and UTs with legislature (Delhi), 90:10 for NE and Himalayan States, 100% Central for UTs without legislature.